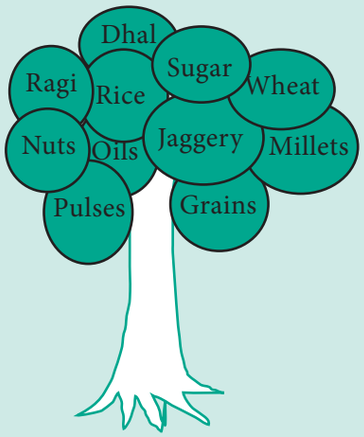
Activity 3

Prepare a weaning food using the following ingredients -



→ ***Pulses:*** Pulses along with cereals in the form of porridge can be given. Pulses and meat preparation can be given alternatively

Unmashed: When the infant starts developing teeth, it is the time to give lumpy foods, cooked cereals and pulses solids like idly, idiappam, bread, chappathi and semi solids like rice and dhal. Vegetables can be chopped and boiled into small pieces. As the child grows, it is better to give fruit segments instead of juice. Fruit provides bulk in the diet and is good for bowel movement.

Problems of Weaning

→ Obesity
→ Underweight
→ Choking
→ Food allergy

6.3 NUTRITIONAL NEEDS OF PRESCHOOL AND SCHOOL GOING CHILDREN

The rapid growth during infancy is followed by a generally slow growth between one to six years. The child becomes more active and the social and environmental influences have a great impact on their food behaviour and eating pattern. The need for nutrients is increased as growth and development continues.

Growth Pattern

During the second year, the increase in height is about 10 cm and weight gain is 2 to 2.5 kg. After two years annual gain in height and weight is only 6 to 7 cm and 1.5 to 2 kg respectively. However, there is a wide variance in the physical development of children.

As growth proceeds, changes occur in a) proportion of water, b) muscle tissue, c) fat deposits and d) skeletal structure. The body water gradually decreases and there is addition of adipose tissue and minerals to the bones.

Nutritional Needs During Preschool

Energy

The energy needs for the child is determined by his basal metabolism and activity. If the preschool child is not given proper complementary foods and supplementary foods, it may lead to protein and energy malnutrition.

Protein

Protein is a vital dietary component for pre-schoolers, as it is needed for optimal growth. Enough protein should be consumed every day for proper growth and development.

Fat

Adequate fat is required to provide the extra calories and reduce bulk in the diet.

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